confusing acronyms further taxes the decipherer.[16] A passage from the DAP reads:

> 'The HQ IDS would now be required to prepare 10-year ICDPs (Integrated Capacity Development Plans) and translate them into appropriate problem definition statements and R&D establishment and industry would be given time and resources to enable transition from technology development for testing, trials and production to take place.'

No wonder that Gen VK Singh, the former COAS (2010–12) had called the acquisition process a deadly game of snakes and ladders, when just as the end seems near, the case slides back right to the bottom.[17] Due to the convoluted process, 'new' equipment that is being inducted is already outdated because of the technological advances that have occurred in the interim. An RBA is therefore the only way the process will improve. Perhaps a system of Line and Staff needs to be introduced to give the bureaucrats dealing with these cases a feel of the ground and instil in them a sense of urgency. When Shri George Fernandes was the RM, he sent two senior bureaucrats to the Siachen Glacier when he came to know that they had held back a file on the purchase of snow scooters for soldiers deployed at the world's highest battlefield.[18] The jawan at the front line couldn't care less where the weapons system comes from, the company that bagged the order or the costs. He just wants the weapon system 'as of yesterday'. What is important, is equipping our men with the best at the fastest possible speed. That should be our bounden duty. Regrettably, the Indian bureaucracy, with the exception of a significant few, is still hung up on a work-to-rule basis with a focus on procedure, not productivity.[19] This approach has even irked the PM and on

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